

A Project Report on
Retailers' Perspective on Use of Technology for Growth of Business:
A study with ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam.



ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam

Submitted in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of Master of Business Administration (MBA) under University of Science and Technology, Meghalaya.

By

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DECLARATION

*I, Aban Keot, **Roll No: 2024/MBA/0045**, a student of Master of Business Administration hereby declare that the report entitled “**Retailers’ Perspective on Use of Technology for Growth of Business: A Study with ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam**” is prepared by me after the completion of two months internship at **ITC Limited, Guwahati** that is from 1st July, 2025 to 31st August, 2025. I also confirm the report is only prepared for my academic requirement and not for any other purpose. This report is submitted solely for academic purpose.*

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I would like to express my sincere gratitude to my project guide and supervisor for their constant support, invaluable guidance, and constructive suggestions throughout the course of this dissertation. Their academic insights and encouragement played a crucial role in the successful completion of this research work.

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I extend my gratitude to the faculty members of my institution for their guidance and support during my academic journey, which enabled me to undertake and complete this dissertation effectively.

Lastly, I am thankful to my family and friends for their continuous encouragement and moral support throughout the process.

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CERTIFICATE

*This is to certify that **Aban Keot** is a student of MBA (2-Year Full Time) Final semester holding University Roll No: 2024/MBA/0045 has completed his project entitled as “**Retailers’ Perspective on Use of Technology for Growth of Business: A study with ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam**” under my supervision. This project report is an original work of the student.*

Neither in full nor in any part of the report has been submitted anywhere for the award of any degree/certificate from any University or Institute.

I wish him all the Best.

*(Dr. Jyoti Hatiboruah)
Assistant Professor
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USTM*

Summer Internship Certificate



ITC Limited
INDIA TOBACCO DIVISION
6TH FLOOR, PEACE ENCLAVE,
G. S. ROAD, ULUBARI, GUWAHATI
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Date: 01/09/2025

TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that Mr. Aban Keot, an MBA student from University Of Science And Technology Meghalaya, was an intern with Trade Marketing and Distribution (TM&D), ITC Limited at Guwahati Marketing Branch, from period 01/07/2024 to 31/08/2025.

During the above period, he worked on the project titled **"How Technology is helping ITC to drive it's business"**

The project completed by him is CONFIDENTIAL in nature and he is not permitted to share the data/findings/recommendations/report to any person or body external to ITC Ltd.

We appreciate his efforts and congratulate him on successfully completing the project.

Mr. Ivan Taso Lepcha
Branch Manager

ITC LIMITED, TM&D Guwahati

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Executive Summary

a. **Title of the Project:** Retailers' Perspective on the Use of Technology for Growth of Business:
A Study with ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam

b. **Period of Project Work:** 2 months (1st July 2025 to 31st August 2025)

c. **Name of the Organisation:** ITC Limited, Guwahati, Assam.

d. **Name of the Organisational Supervisor:** Mr. Sankhabrata Datta and Ms. Asha Soni, HR
Manager

e. **Name and Designation of the Institutional Supervisor:** Dr. Jyoti Hatiboruah, Assistant
Professor, Department of Business Administration

f. **Highlights of Findings:**

- **Universal Adoption of Technology:** All retailers surveyed are using some form of technology such as UPI, WhatsApp, or billing software, indicating that digital tools have become an essential part of retail operations.
- **Dominance of Basic Digital Tools:** UPI is the most commonly used tool, adopted by all 21 retailers (100%), followed by ITC's Unnati App (47.62%) and WhatsApp (42.86%). Billing software has the lowest adoption at 14.29%.
- **Key Reasons for Adoption of Technology by Retailers:** Retailers primarily adopt technology due to customer demand, saving time, ensuring transparency, and tracking sales efficiently.
- **Improved Ease of Doing Business:** Technology has simplified business operations by making order placement easier, improving awareness of schemes, reducing errors, and supporting better record maintenance.
- **Ease of Learning Technology:** Retailers reported mixed experiences regarding the ease of learning technology. While some found digital tools easy to use, others faced difficulties in adapting to them.
- **Retailer Experience with Technology:** Adoption of ITC's Unnati App remains limited among retailers, and users reported mixed views regarding its usefulness.
- **Minor Operational Issues:** Some retailers reported occasional issues related to usability and technical support, indicating scope for improvement.
- **Technology as a Growth Driver:** A majority of retailers believe that technology plays a significant role in improving business efficiency and supporting long-term growth.

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

In the modern business environment, technology has become an integral part of daily operations, especially in the retail sector. The increasing use of digital tools such as mobile payments, billing systems, inventory management software, and communication platforms has transformed the way retailers conduct their business. These technologies help in improving efficiency, reducing manual work, and enhancing customer satisfaction.

In India, the adoption of digital technology in retail has grown rapidly in recent years due to increased smartphone penetration, affordable internet access, and government initiatives promoting digital transactions. Tools like Unified Payments Interface (UPI), QR code payments, and mobile-based applications have made financial transactions faster, more secure, and convenient for both retailers and customers.

Retailers, particularly in the Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) sector, are increasingly adopting technology to stay competitive in the market. Technology enables them to manage their inventory efficiently, track sales, maintain records, and communicate effectively with suppliers and customers. It also plays a crucial role in reducing errors and improving decision-making.

ITC Limited, one of India's leading FMCG companies, has established a strong distribution network that connects manufacturers, distributors, and retailers. Retailers play a vital role in ensuring the availability of ITC products to the final consumers. With the increasing importance of technology in retail operations, it becomes essential to understand how retailers associated with ITC are adopting and utilizing technology in their business.

1.2. Literature Review

1.2.1 Concept of Technology in Retail Business

Technology in retail refers to the use of digital tools and systems to manage and improve various business operations such as billing, inventory management, customer communication, and order processing. The use of technology helps retailers streamline their operations, reduce manual errors, and improve overall efficiency.

Retail technology includes a wide range of tools such as Point of Sale (POS) systems, mobile payment platforms, enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems, and mobile applications. These tools enable retailers to automate routine tasks, maintain accurate records, and make informed decisions.

The adoption of technology in retail is influenced by several factors such as ease of use, cost, accessibility, and perceived benefits. Retailers are more likely to adopt technology when it provides clear advantages such as time-saving, convenience, and improved customer service.

1.2.2 Digital Payments and Their Role in Retail

Digital payment systems have become one of the most important technological innovations in the retail sector. In India, the introduction of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has revolutionized the way financial transactions are conducted. UPI enables instant money transfer through mobile devices, making transactions faster, more secure, and convenient.

The growth of digital payments has significantly reduced the dependency on cash transactions. Retailers benefit from digital payments as they eliminate the need for handling cash, reduce the risk of theft, and provide better transaction records. Customers also prefer digital payments due to their convenience and speed.

The adoption of digital payments has also contributed to financial inclusion by enabling small retailers and vendors to participate in the formal financial system. It has improved transparency and accountability in business transactions.

1.2.3 Technology Adoption in Retail Sector

Several studies have examined the adoption of technology in the retail sector, particularly among small and medium retailers. A study conducted in Dehradun (2023) found that digital payment platforms have significantly improved the business operations of vegetable vendors. The study revealed that a majority of vendors prefer digital payments due to their convenience, time-saving nature, and ease of use.

Similarly, a study conducted in Mysore (2025) analyzed the adoption of digital payments among micro-businesses. The study found that platforms such as PhonePe and Paytm are widely used due to their user-friendly interface and wide acceptance among customers. The study also highlighted that customer demand plays an important role in influencing technology adoption.

Another study conducted in North Delhi (2023) examined the perception of small shop vendors towards digital payment methods. The findings indicated that digital payments have become an essential part of retail business and are widely accepted by small vendors.

However, a study conducted in Mumbai and Bengaluru (2018) found that the adoption of digital payments increased significantly during demonetization but declined after the availability of cash improved. This suggests that external factors such as government policies and economic conditions also influence technology adoption.

1.2.4 Theoretical Framework: Technology Acceptance Model

The Technology Acceptance Model is one of the most widely used models to understand technology adoption behavior. According to TAM, the adoption of technology is influenced by two main factors:

- **Perceived Usefulness (PU):** The degree to which a person believes that using a particular technology will improve their performance.
- **Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU):** The degree to which a person believes that using a technology will be free from effort.

Studies have shown that when retailers perceive technology as useful and easy to use, they are more likely to adopt it. Trust, security, and social influence also play an important role in influencing technology adoption.

1.2.5 Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology

The Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology extends the TAM model by including additional factors such as:

- Performance Expectancy
- Effort Expectancy
- Social Influence
- Facilitating Conditions

Research has shown that these factors significantly influence the adoption of digital payment systems and mobile technologies. For example, studies on mobile wallet adoption have found that trust, security, and ease of use are key determinants of user behavior.

1.2.6 Retailers' Experience with Technology

The experience of retailers in using technology is an important factor in determining its continued use. Studies have shown that retailers who have a positive experience with digital tools are more likely to continue using them and recommend them to others.

A study on digital financial services (2022) found that factors such as ease of use, timeliness, and familiarity significantly influence user experience. Retailers who are comfortable with technology tend to use it more effectively and efficiently.

1.2.7 Challenges in Technology Adoption

Despite the benefits, retailers face several challenges in adopting technology. A study conducted in Dehradun (2023) found that some vendors faced difficulties due to low digital literacy and lack of technical knowledge.

Other common challenges include network connectivity issues, security concerns, and fear of fraud. Studies have also highlighted that lack of proper training and support can hinder the adoption of technology.

1.2.8 Studies

Dr. Alka Suri and Anshu Rawat (2023) conducted a study in Dehradun, and examined the role of digital platforms in improving the lives of vegetable vendors in the unorganized sector. The objective of the study was to analyze the adoption of digital payment methods and their impact on business operations. The findings revealed that a majority of vendors preferred digital payments due to their ease of use and time-saving nature. Around 87% of respondents reported that digital payments facilitated easy transfer of money to bank accounts, while 84% found them time-saving. However, some vendors faced initial difficulties due to low digital literacy. Study highlighted that digital payments significantly improve efficiency and financial inclusion but require proper training for effective adoption.

Dr. Nanda Kishore Shetty (2025) focused on the adoption of UPI among micro-businesses in Mysore. The research aimed to analyze awareness, usage patterns, and challenges associated with digital payment systems. The study found that platforms like PhonePe and Paytm were widely used due to their convenience and early adoption. Customer demand emerged as a key factor influencing the use of digital payments. However, some businesses reported no significant impact on

profitability. This study concluded that digital payments enhance operational efficiency, but their direct impact on profit may vary.

Shailesh Rastogi, Chetan Panse, Arpita Sharma and Venkata Mrudula Bhimavarapu (2021)

This study examined the impact of UPI on financial inclusion and economic development in India. Using structural equation modeling, the study established relationships between financial literacy, financial inclusion, and economic growth.

The findings indicated that UPI improves financial literacy, which in turn enhances financial inclusion and contributes to economic development. Trust and financial stability were identified as important mediating factors. Study highlighted that UPI plays a crucial role in improving financial inclusion and economic development.

Sunil Bhatia, Suruchi Satsangi and Rajeev (2023)

A study conducted in North Delhi analyzed the perception of small shop vendors towards digital payment methods. The study used primary data collected from 60 respondents.

The findings revealed that digital payments are widely accepted and considered an important part of modern business. The adoption of digital payments was seen as a positive development for the retail sector. This study concluded that Digital payment systems are becoming a standard practice among small retailers.

Joyojeet Pal, Priyank Chandra, Vaishnav Kameswaran, Aakanksha Parameshwar, Sneha Joshi and Aditya Johri (2018)

This study examined the impact of demonetization on digital payment adoption among shopkeepers in Mumbai and Bengaluru. The study found that digital payment usage increased significantly during the cash shortage period.

However, once cash became available, the usage of digital payments declined. The study also highlighted that adoption depends on factors such as transaction type and familiarity with technology. Study highlighted that, external factors strongly influence technology adoption among retailers.

Prabhakar Nandru and S. A. Senthilkumar (2024)

This study explored the factors influencing mobile payment adoption among women street vendors in India using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

The findings showed that perceived usefulness, ease of use, and trust significantly influence adoption. Social influence was found to be less significant. Study highlighted that Trust and usability are key determinants of technology adoption.

Dhananjay Bapat (2022)

This study examined the relationship between lifestyle, digital financial elements, and user experience. The study used both qualitative and quantitative methods.

The findings indicated that ease of use, timeliness, and familiarity positively affect user experience. Lifestyle was found to mediate the relationship between technology and user experience. Study highlighted that user experience plays a crucial role in technology adoption and continued usage.

Sumedha Chauhan (2015)

This study analyzed the acceptance of mobile money among low-income groups in India using the Technology Acceptance Model.

The findings highlighted that trust and perceived usefulness significantly influence adoption. However, ease of use was not found to have a significant impact. Study highlighted that trust is a critical factor in technology adoption among low-income users.

Deepak Chawla and Himanshu Joshi (2019)

This study examined the factors influencing consumer adoption of mobile wallets. The study used a large sample size and applied statistical models.

The findings revealed that perceived usefulness, ease of use, trust, and security significantly influence adoption behavior. The conclusion of the states that multiple factors, including psychological and functional aspects, influence technology adoption.

Mayank Kumar, Jang Bahadur Singh and Sujeet Kumar Sharma (2025)

This study analyzed the adoption process of UPI among micro-enterprises in India. It focused on the interaction between technological opportunities and challenges.

The findings indicated that while new features improve usability, they also introduce challenges such as fraud risks and complexity. Study highlighted that technology adoption is a dynamic process influenced by both opportunities and constraints.

Poulami Saha and Kunjangada B. Kiran (2022)

This study explored the factors influencing UPI adoption among older users. It found that factors such as perceived security, performance expectancy, and social influence play a significant role. The study also highlighted the impact of COVID-19 in accelerating digital adoption. Study highlighted that, external factors and perceived security significantly influence adoption behavior.

Anupkumar Dhore, Vijay D. Joshi, Amir Hafizullah Khan and Sukanta Kumar Baral (2023)

This study examined the growth and transformation of digital payments in India. It highlighted the role of government initiatives and technological advancements in promoting digital transactions.

The findings suggested that digital payments are expected to grow further due to increased acceptance and improved infrastructure.

Study concluded that Digital payments are a key driver of technological transformation in the retail sector.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

Following are the objectives that set for this study:

1. To identify the reasons for adopting technology in retail business.
2. To explore the areas where technology improves ease of doing business.
3. To study the experiences of retailers in using technology in ITC-related business.

1.4 Scope of the Study

The study focuses on retailers associated with ITC Limited in Guwahati city. It examines the use of technology in various aspects of their business operations, such as payment systems, inventory management, communication, and order processing. The study is limited to a specific geographical area and may not represent the entire retail sector.

1.4.1 Contribution to the Organisation

The findings of this study will help ITC Limited understand the extent to which retailers are adopting and utilizing technology in their business operations. The study identifies the key reasons behind technology adoption and highlights the areas where technology contributes to ease of doing business. By understanding retailers' experiences with digital tools, ITC can evaluate the effectiveness of its technological initiatives and identify opportunities for improving retailer engagement, digital support, and business efficiency.

1.4.2 Contribution to Academia

The study contributes to the existing body of knowledge on technology adoption in the retail sector, particularly in the context of retailer-business relationships. It provides empirical evidence on the role of technology in improving business operations and retailer experiences. The findings may serve as a reference for future researchers, students, and academicians interested in digital transformation, retail technology, technology adoption, and business process improvement in emerging markets.

1.5 Limitations of the Study

The study is subject to certain limitations that should be considered while interpreting the findings. Firstly, the study was conducted only in selected retail areas of Guwahati, namely Krishna Nagar, Ganeshguri, Zoo Road, Jayanagar, Survey, and Ghoramara. Therefore, the findings may not fully represent the perspectives of retailers operating in other parts of Guwahati or Assam. Secondly, the study was carried out within a limited time frame, which restricted the scope of data collection and analysis. In addition, the sample size of 21 retailers was relatively small, which may affect the generalizability of the findings. The study also relies on the responses and perceptions of retailers, which may be influenced by personal opinions, recall bias, or incomplete information. Despite these limitations, the study provides useful insights into the adoption and use of technology by retailers associated with ITC Limited.

1.6 Research Methodology

1.6.1 Data Collection Method: Sample Size, Method of Sampling and Source of Data

The study uses both Judgmental and convenience sampling methods. As initially judgmental sampling technique was implemented to select the ITC retailers in the designated study area where conditions were put like size of operation scale i.e., medium size, locality, footfall. Next, convenience sampling technique was considered that means the respondents were selected based on accessibility and willingness to participate. A total of 21 retailers from Krishna Nagar, Ganeshguri, Zoo Road, Jayanagar, Survey, and Ghoramara areas of Guwahati were surveyed for the study. The collected data were analyzed using percentage analysis and mean score analysis.

Tables and graphs were used to present and interpret the findings in a systematic manner. The sampling unit includes grocery stores, wholesalers, and departmental stores.

The study is based on both primary and secondary data.

- **Primary Data:** Primary data was collected directly from retailers associated with ITC in Guwahati through a structured questionnaire. The questionnaire included both close-ended and open-ended questions to gather detailed insights.
- **Secondary Data:** Secondary data was collected from various sources such as:
 - Research papers and journals
 - Company reports and official websites
 - Articles related to digital payments and retail technology
 - ITC Annual Reports

Chapter 2

About the Organisation

2.1 Introduction to ITC Limited

ITC Limited is one of India's leading diversified conglomerates with a strong presence across multiple business segments, including Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG), Hotels, Paperboards and Packaging, and Agri-Business. Established in 1910, the company has evolved into a prominent organisation known for its innovation, sustainability, and strong market presence.

The company has demonstrated consistent financial performance and has built a reputation for maintaining high standards of corporate governance. ITC is also recognized globally for its sustainability initiatives, being carbon positive, water positive, and solid waste recycling positive. Through its operations and value chain, the company supports the livelihoods of millions of people, particularly in rural India.

2.2 Business Segments of ITC

ITC operates through a diversified business model, leveraging synergies across its different verticals. Its major business segments include:

- FMCG (Fast-Moving Consumer Goods)
- Cigarettes
- Hotels
- Paperboards, Paper and Packaging
- Agri-Business

Among these, the FMCG segment has emerged as a key driver of growth, with a strong portfolio of products catering to daily consumer needs. The company's diversified structure helps in risk reduction and ensures long-term sustainability.

The integration of different business segments enables ITC to create value through a combination of manufacturing, distribution, and marketing capabilities supported by a strong supply chain network.

16. Details of business activities: (accounting for 90% of the entity's Turnover):

S. No.	Description Of Main Activity	Description Of Business Activity	% Of Turnover Of The Entity
1.	FMCG	Cigarettes	44.42%
		Others: Branded Packaged Foods Businesses (Staples & Meals; Snacks; Dairy & Beverages; Biscuits & Cakes; Chocolates, Coffee & Confectionery); Personal Care Products; Education and Stationery Products; Safety Matches and Agarbattis.	29.91%
2.	Agri-Business	Agri-commodities such as wheat, rice, spices, coffee, soya and leaf tobacco.	16.42%
3.	Paperboards, Paper & Packaging	Paperboards, Paper including Specialty Paper & Packaging including flexibles.	9.02%

Figure 1: ITC's Business Activity. (Source: ITC Annual Report)

2.3 FMCG Segment of ITC

The FMCG segment is one of the most important divisions of ITC, contributing significantly to its overall growth. The company offers a wide range of products, including packaged foods, personal care products, and household items.

Some of ITC's well-known brands include Aashirvaad, Sunfeast, Bingo, Yippee, Candyman, and B-Natural. These brands have gained strong consumer acceptance due to quality, innovation, and effective distribution strategies.

The FMCG business focuses on meeting the everyday needs of consumers while maintaining affordability and accessibility. The company continuously invests in product development and marketing to strengthen its position in the highly competitive FMCG sector.



Figure 2 Product Portfolio of ITC (Source: ITC website)

2.4 ITC Distribution Network

ITC has developed a robust and efficient distribution network that plays a crucial role in ensuring product availability across urban and rural markets. The distribution system connects manufacturers, warehouses, distributors, and retailers in a structured manner.

Retailers act as the final link in the supply chain, ensuring that products reach end consumers. The distribution network is supported by a strong logistics system that enables timely delivery and efficient inventory management.

The company's extensive reach allows it to penetrate deep into rural markets, making its products widely accessible. This strong distribution capability is one of ITC's key competitive advantages.

2.5 Digital Transformation at ITC

ITC has embraced digital transformation as a core strategy to enhance efficiency, improve decision-making, and strengthen its business operations. The company has developed a comprehensive digital ecosystem that integrates various functions across its value chain.

Initiatives such as Mission DigiArc aim to create a “digital-first” organisation by connecting different stakeholders, including factories, warehouses, distributors, and retailers. Digital platforms are used for data analytics, marketing, supply chain management, and customer engagement.

The company also uses advanced technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI), data analytics, and automation to optimize operations and improve productivity. These initiatives help ITC remain competitive in a rapidly evolving business environment.

ITC uses multiple digital platforms such as Vajra, Unnati, Trishul, PACE, and Lighthouse to enhance operational efficiency and decision-making.

2.6 Role of Technology in Retail and Distribution

Technology plays a significant role in ITC’s retail and distribution operations by improving efficiency, reducing errors, and enhancing coordination among different stakeholders.

Digital tools enable real-time order processing, inventory tracking, and communication between distributors and retailers. These systems ensure that products are delivered efficiently and that demand and supply are well coordinated.

Applications such as sales force automation systems and retailer platforms simplify the order-taking process and provide valuable insights for decision-making. Technology also helps in maintaining transparency and improving accountability in the distribution process.

Overall, the integration of technology into retail and distribution has enabled ITC to strengthen its market presence and improve operational effectiveness.

Chapter 3

Analysis and Interpretation of Data

3.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of primary data collected from 21 retailers in Guwahati. The data has been analyzed using percentage method and presented through charts and tables. The analysis is carried out in accordance with the objectives of the study.

3.2 Profile of Respondents

3.2.1 Area-wise Distribution

Table 1: Area wise distribution of respondents

Area	Grocery Store	Warehouse	Departmental Store	Total
Krishna Nagar	8	0	1	9
Ganeshguri	0	4	0	4
Zoo Road	5	0	0	5
Ghoramara	1	0	0	1
Survey	1	0	0	1
Jayanagar	1	0	0	1
Total	16	4	1	21

Findings and Interpretation:

The respondents for the study were selected from different market areas of Guwahati, namely Krishna Nagar, Ganeshguri, Zoo Road, Ghoramara, Survey, and Jayanagar. Krishna Nagar accounted for the highest number of respondents (42.86%), followed by Zoo Road (23.81%) and Ganeshguri (19.05%). Ghoramara, Survey, and Jayanagar each contributed 4.76% of the total respondents. The respondents were selected from identified market areas of Guwahati using judgmental and convenience sampling techniques. The distribution reflects the selection of ITC retailers that met the study criteria relating to operation scale, locality, and footfall, while also considering the accessibility and willingness of respondents to participate in the survey.

3.2.2 Type of Shop

Table 2: Types of Shop

Types of Shop	Frequency
Grocery	16
Wholesaler	4
Departmental stores	1

(Source: Primary Data)

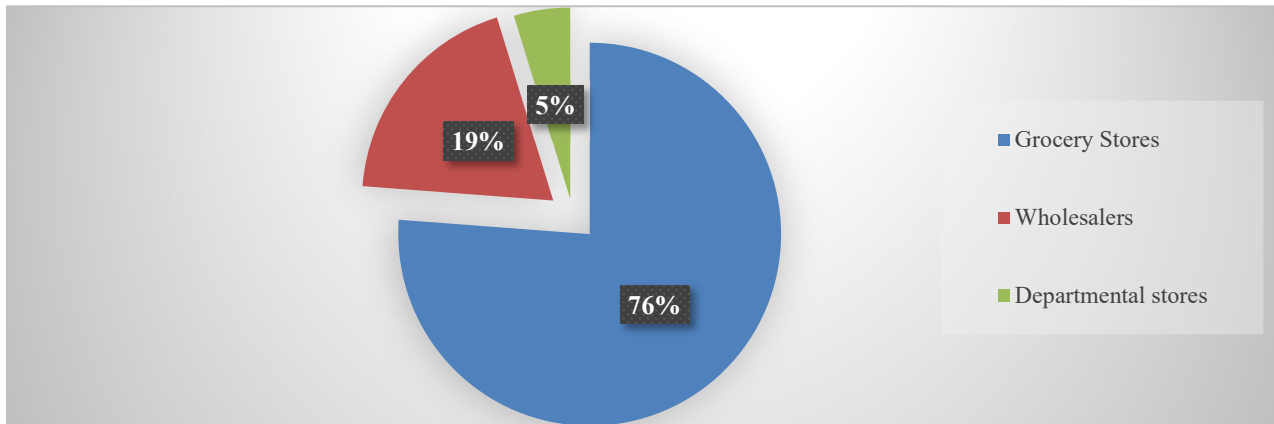


Figure 3 Types of Stores (Source Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: Out of 21 respondents, 76% are grocery stores, 19 % wholesalers, and only 5 % are departmental stores. The majority of respondents are grocery stores (76%), followed by wholesalers (19%) and departmental stores (5%). This indicates that the study primarily reflects the perspectives of grocery retailers, who constitute the largest segment among the surveyed ITC retailers.

3.2.3 Average Daily Footfall

Table 3: Average Daily Footfall store-wise

Type of Store	Average Daily Footfall (Approx.)	Percentage
Grocery Store	72	29.75%
Departmental Store	65	26.86%
Wholesaler	105	43.39%
Total	242	100%

(Source: Primary Data)

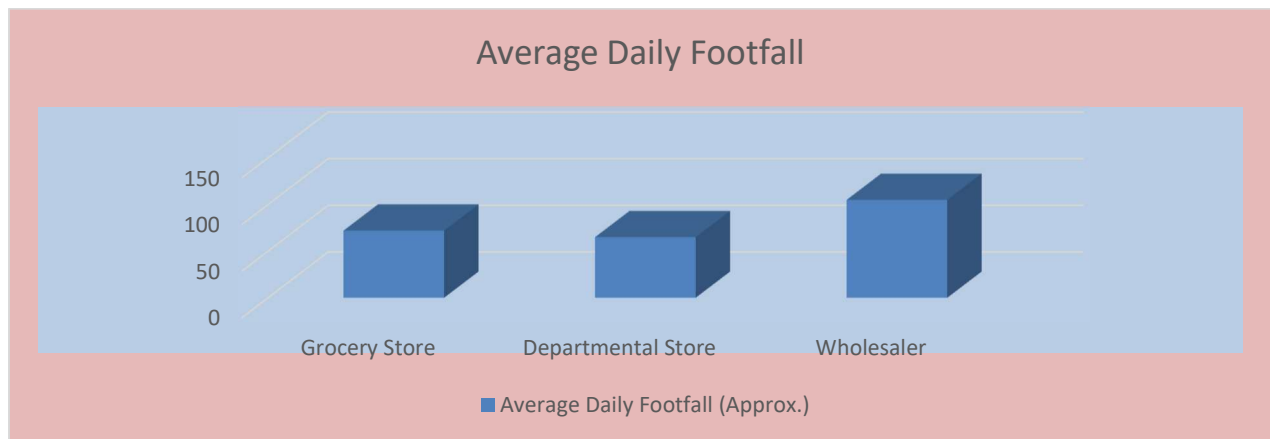


Figure 4 Average daily Footfall (Source Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The data shows that wholesalers recorded the highest average daily footfall (105 customers), followed by grocery stores (72 customers) and departmental stores (65 customers). This indicates that wholesalers experience comparatively higher customer traffic among the surveyed retailers. One possible reason is that the wholesalers included in the study were located in the Ganeshguri market area, which attracts a large number of visitors. In addition to local consumers, wholesalers also receive customers from other retail outlets purchasing goods in bulk. Furthermore, wholesalers often offer products at comparatively lower prices, which may attract more customers. Although grocery stores were greater in number, their customer base is generally limited to nearby residential areas. Higher customer visits may create greater opportunities for sales and business transactions, highlighting the importance of efficient inventory and service management.

3.2.4 Years of Association with ITC

Table 4: Years of association

Years of Association	Frequency
Less than a Year	2
1-3 Years	6
3-5 Years	8
5-10 Years	2
More than 10 Years	3

(Source Primary Data)

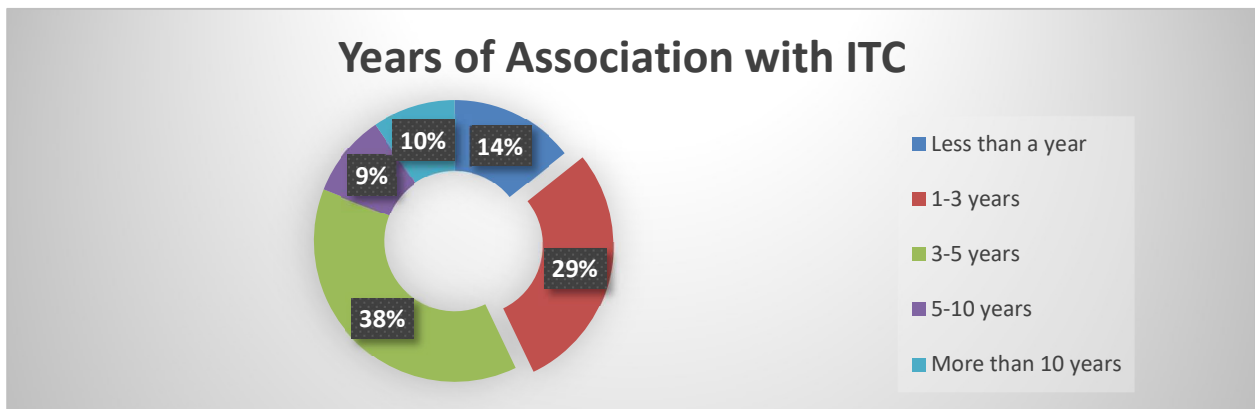


Figure 5 Years of Association with ITC (Source Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: About 38.10% of retailers have been associated with ITC for 3–5 years, followed by 28.57% for 1–3 years. Retailers with less than one year of association account for 14.29%, while 9.52% each have been associated with ITC for 5–10 years and more than 10 years. The findings indicate that most respondents have maintained an association with ITC for more than one year, suggesting a reasonably experienced retailer base familiar with ITC's products and business practices.

3.3 Analysis Based on Objective 1: Reasons for Using Technology by retailers

Table 5: Reasons for Using Technology by Retailers

Reasons for Using Technology	HIF	IF	AIF	NIF	HNIF	Mean Score
Due to Customer Demand	11	8	3	1	0	4.66
Saves Time	12	8	1	0	0	4.52
Easy to Keep/Maintain Records	12	9	0	0	0	4.57
Easy to Track Sales	10	9	2	0	0	4.38
Transparency	9	8	2	2	0	4.04

(Source: Primary Data)

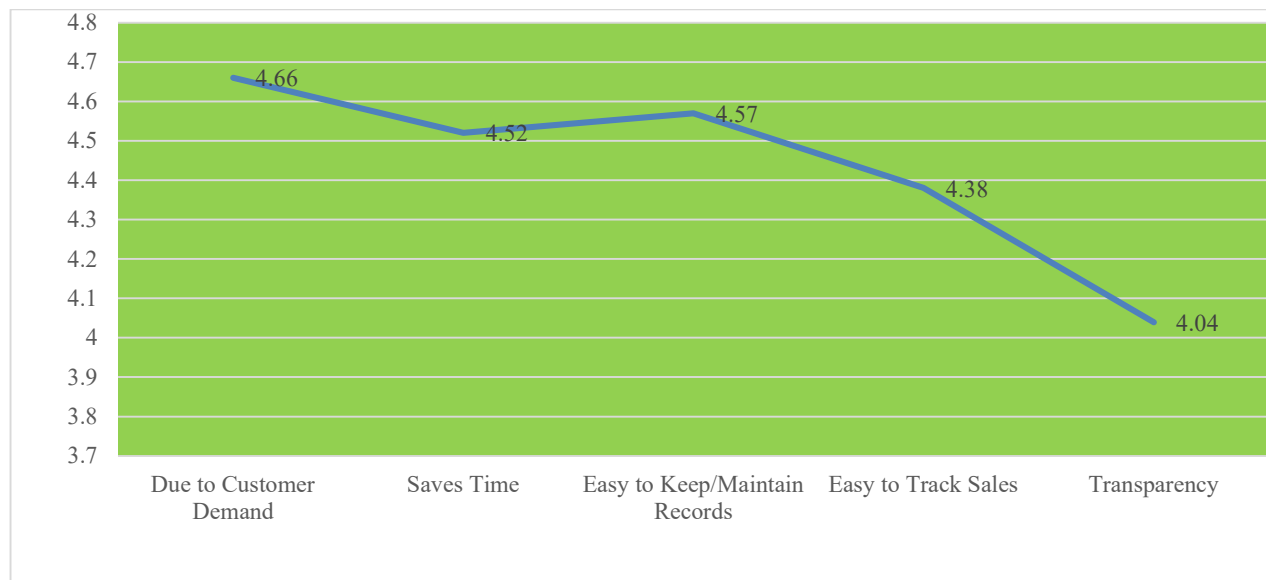


Figure 6 Reason for Using Technology by Retailers (Source Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The findings indicate that customer demand is the primary reason for adopting technology, as reported by 95.24% of the respondents. This is followed by time-saving benefits (85.71%) and ease of maintaining records (71.43%). Nearly half of the retailers stated that technology helps them track sales more effectively, while 33.33% highlighted transparency as a reason for adoption. Overall, the results suggest that retailers primarily adopt technology to meet customer expectations, improve operational efficiency, maintain business records more effectively, and facilitate better monitoring of sales activities.

3.3.1 Retailers who use Technology

Table 6: Retailers who use Technology

Response	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Yes	21	100
No	0	0
Total	21	100

(Source: Primary Data)

All respondents (100%) reported that they use some form of technology in their business operations, including digital payments, billing systems, or communication platforms.



Figure 7 Retailers who use Technology (Source Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The findings indicate that all surveyed retailers use some form of technology in their business operations, such as digital payment systems, communication platforms, or business management tools. This suggests that technology has become an integral part of retail business activities and is widely accepted among ITC retailers in the selected study areas.

3.3.2 Technologies Used by Retailers

Table 7: Technologies Used by Retailers.

Technology Used	Frequency	Percentage (%)
UPI	21	100
ITC Unnati App	10	47.62
WhatsApp for Order Placement	9	42.86
Billing Software	3	14.29
Total Respondents	21	

(Source: Primary Data)

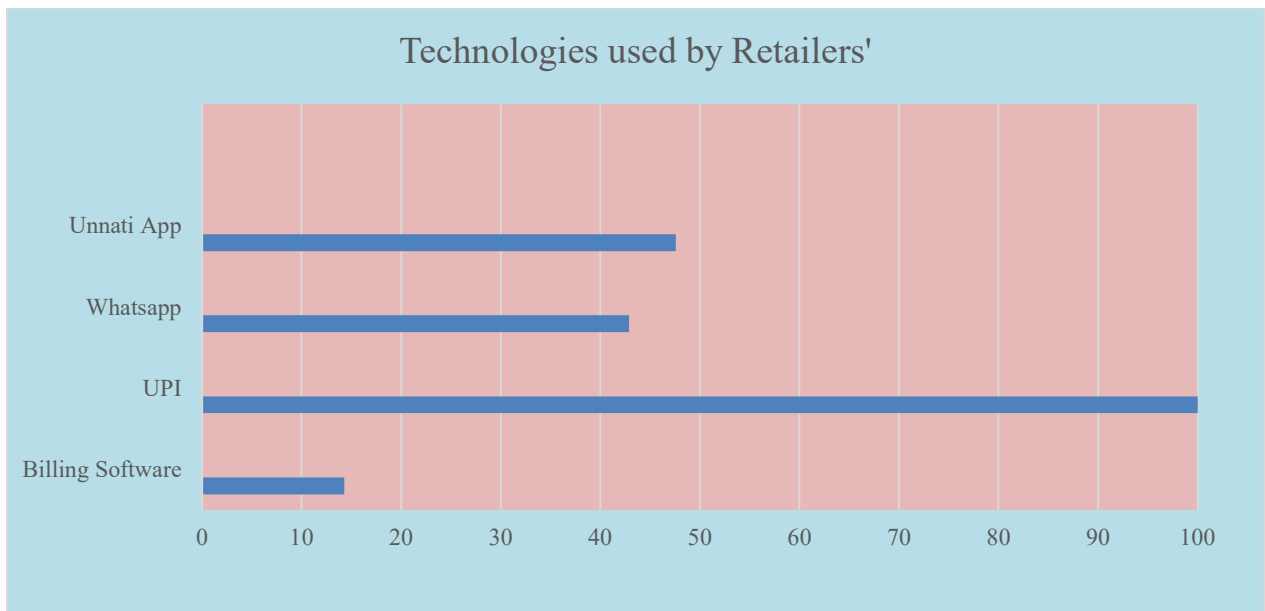


Figure 8 Technologies used by Retailers (Source: Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The analysis of technologies used by retailers indicates that UPI is the most widely adopted digital tool, with 100% of respondents using it for business transactions. This is followed by ITC's Unnati App (47.62%) and WhatsApp (42.86%), while billing software is used by a smaller proportion of retailers (14.29%).

The findings suggest that retailers primarily rely on simple and accessible digital payment systems such as UPI. Although other tools like WhatsApp and Unnati App are used, their adoption is comparatively lower. This indicates that while digital adoption is present, the usage of more structured or integrated systems remains limited.

3.4 Analysis Based on Objective 2: Ease of Doing Business

3.4.1 Impact of Technology on Ease of Doing Business

Table 8: Impact of Technology on Ease of Doing Business

Statements	SA (5)	A (4)	N (3)	DA (2)	SDA (1)	Mean Score
Order placement is easy	2	5	9	4	1	3.14
Technology improves scheme awareness	2	1	7	4	7	2.38
Technology reduces errors	3	9	6	2	1	3.52
Helps in maintaining records	7	12	2	0	0	4.24

(Source Primary Data)

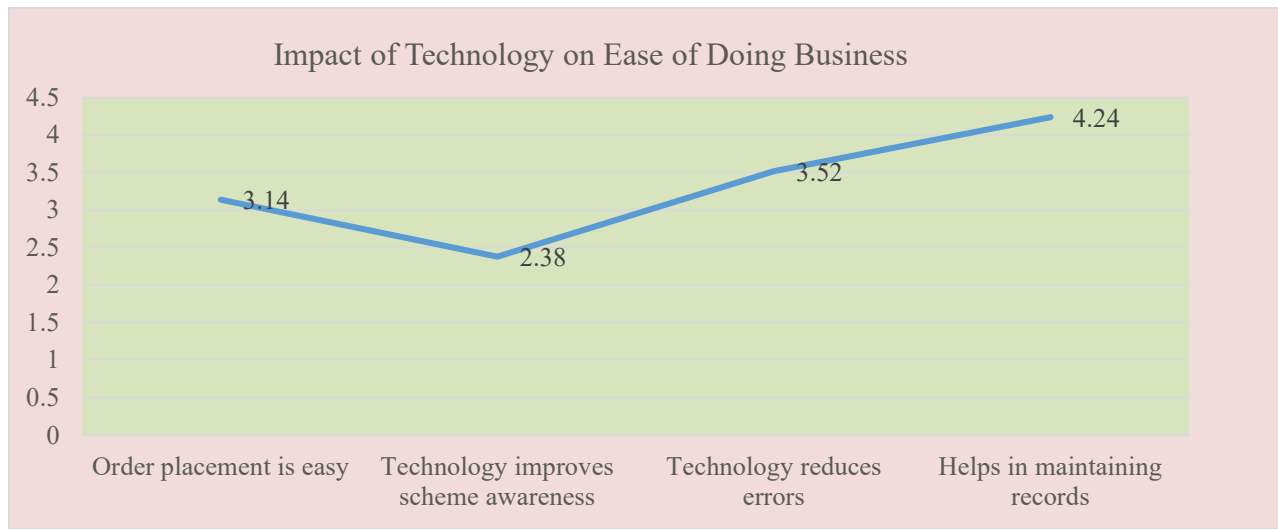


Figure 9 Impact of Technology on Ease of Doing Business. (Source Primary Data)

Finding and Interpretation: The responses indicate that technology has influenced different aspects of business operations such as order placement, scheme awareness, error reduction, and record maintenance. The mean score analysis was used to assess the extent of this impact.

The mean score analysis indicates that retailers perceive technology as highly effective in maintaining business records, with the highest mean score of 4.24. Technology also contributes positively to reducing errors and improving order placement, reflected by moderate mean scores of 3.52 and 3.14 respectively. However, scheme awareness has a relatively lower mean score of 2.38, suggesting that retailers are less aware of schemes despite using digital tools. Overall, the findings show that while technology enhances operational efficiency, there is scope for improvement in communication and awareness-related aspects.

3.4.2 Order Placement Ease.

Table 9: Order Placement Ease

Statement	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Very Difficult	1	4.76
Difficult	4	19.05
Neutral	9	42.86
Easy	5	23.81
Very Easy	2	9.52
Total	21	100

(Source: Primary Data)

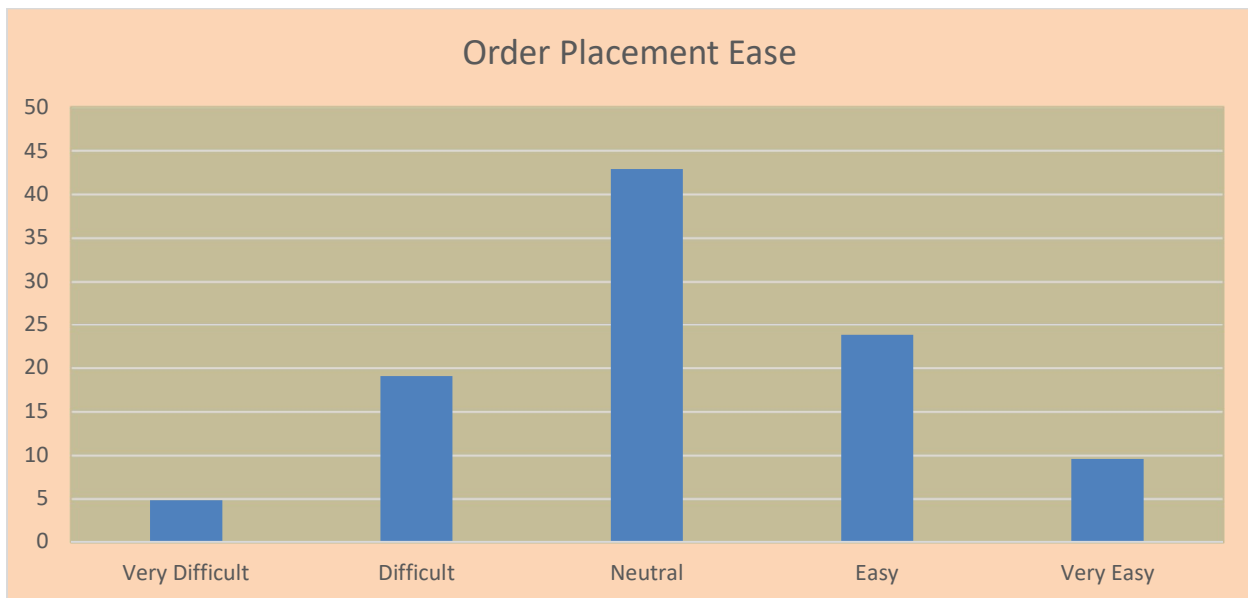


Figure 10 Order Placement Ease (Source: Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The findings indicate a moderate level of ease in order placement through technology among the surveyed retailers. The highest proportion of respondents (42.86%) provided a neutral rating, suggesting that many retailers neither found the process particularly easy nor difficult. A combined 33.33% of respondents rated order placement as easy or very easy, indicating that technology has helped simplify the ordering process for a significant number of retailers. On the other hand, 23.81% of respondents perceived the process as difficult or very difficult, highlighting that some retailers continue to face challenges while placing orders through technological platforms.

The results suggest that technology has positively influenced the order placement process by improving convenience and reducing manual effort. However, the predominance of neutral responses indicates that the benefits are not uniformly experienced across all retailers. Differences in digital literacy, familiarity with technological tools, internet connectivity, and individual preferences may contribute to these varied perceptions. Overall, technology has contributed to making order placement more convenient, but there remains scope for improving user-friendliness, accessibility, and retailer support to enhance the overall experience.

3.4.3 Awareness of ITC Schemes through Technology

Table 10: Awareness of ITC Schemes through Technology

Statement	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Very Low Awareness	7	33.33
Low Awareness	4	19.05
Moderate Awareness	7	33.33
High Awareness	1	4.76
Very High Awareness	2	9.52
Total	21	100

(Source: Primary Data)

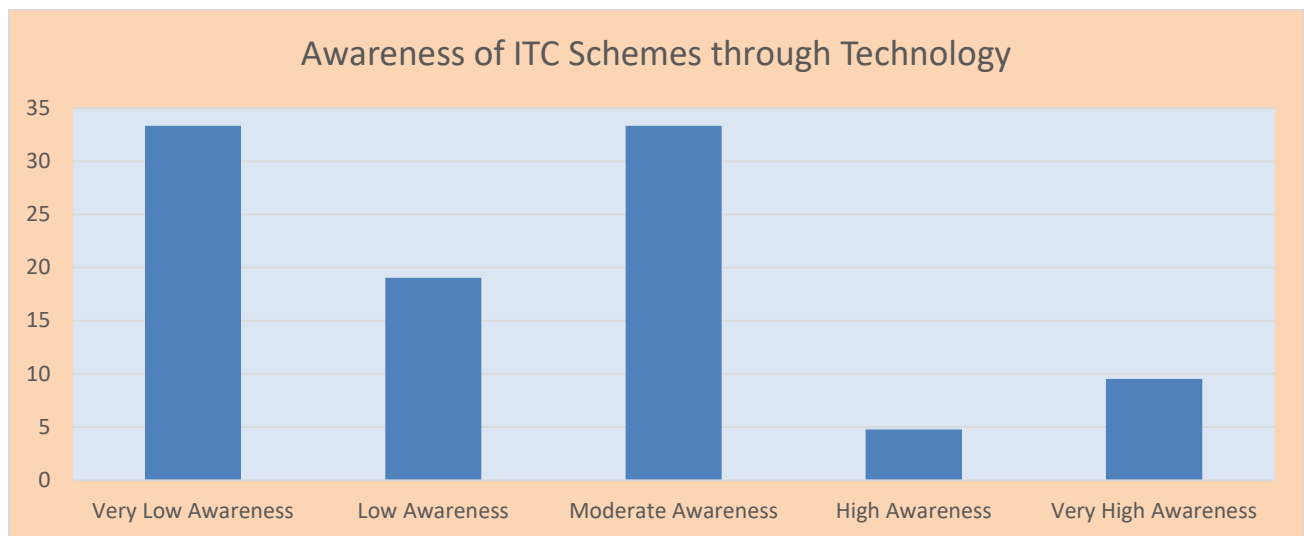


Figure 11 Awareness of ITC Schemes through Technology (Source: Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The responses indicate a relatively low level of awareness regarding ITC schemes among retailers. About 33.33% of respondents rated their awareness level as 1, while another 33.33% rated it as 3. Only 14.28% of respondents rated their awareness level as 4 or 5. The calculated mean score of 2.38 further indicates that awareness of ITC schemes among the surveyed retailers is below the average level. The findings suggest that many retailers have limited awareness of ITC schemes and promotional programs. This highlights the need for improved communication, retailer engagement, and awareness-building initiatives to ensure that retailers can fully benefit from the schemes offered by the company.

3.5 Analysis Based on Objective 3: Retailers' Experience

Table 11: Retailers' Experience with Technology

Statements	SA (5)	A (4)	N (3)	DA (2)	SDA (1)	Mean Score
Technology is easy to learn	1	6	3	5	6	2.57
ITC provides adequate technical support (Note: 11 respondents selected N/A as they were not users of ITC's Unnati App.)	0	0	5	4	2	2.50
Technology is important for business growth	12	5	4	0	0	4.38

(Source: Primary Data)

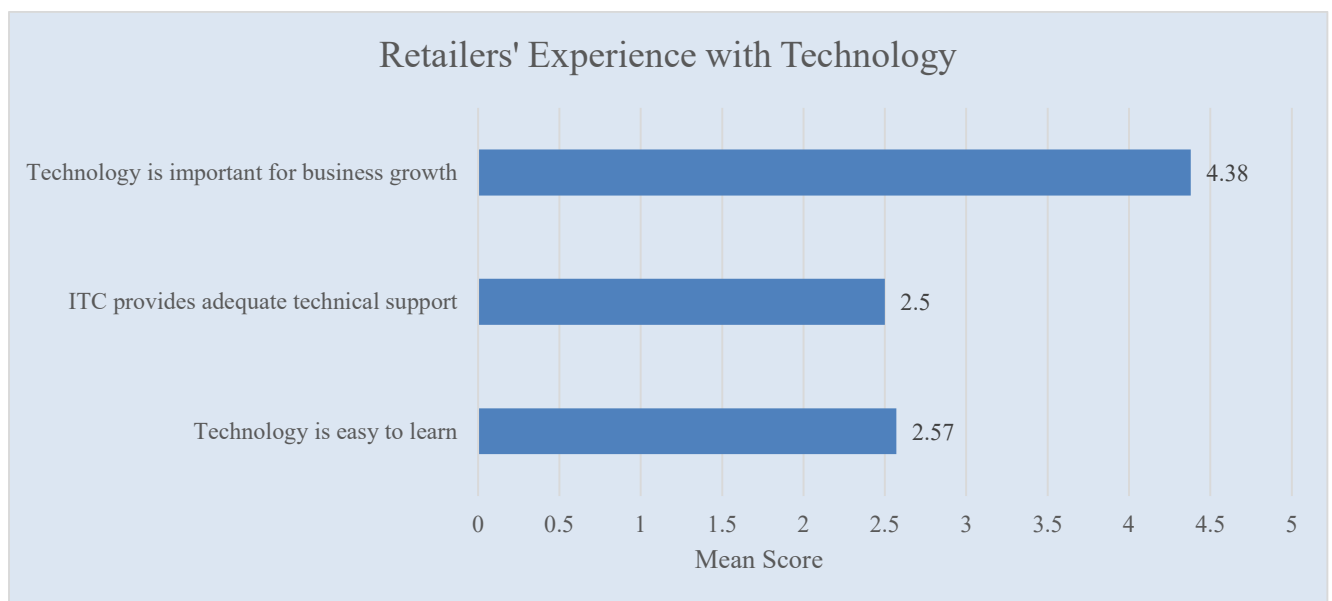


Figure 12 Retailers' Experience with Technology (Source: Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The mean score analysis indicates mixed experiences among retailers regarding technology usage. Retailers strongly agree that technology is important for business growth, as reflected by the highest mean score of 4.38. In contrast, the mean scores for ease of learning technology (2.57) and adequacy of technical support from ITC (2.50) are comparatively lower. These findings suggest that while retailers recognize the importance of technology in supporting business growth, challenges remain in terms of ease of adoption and technical assistance. The results indicate a need for improved training, guidance, and technical support to enhance the overall retailer experience with technology

3.5.1 Helpfulness of Unnati App

Table 12: Helpfulness of Unnati App

Response Category	Frequency	Percentage (%)
Highly Helpful	1	4.76
Very Helpful	2	9.52
Moderately Helpful	2	9.52
Slightly Helpful	3	14.29
Not at all Helpful	2	9.52
N/A (Not Using Unnati App)	11	52.38
Total	21	100

(Source: Primary Data)

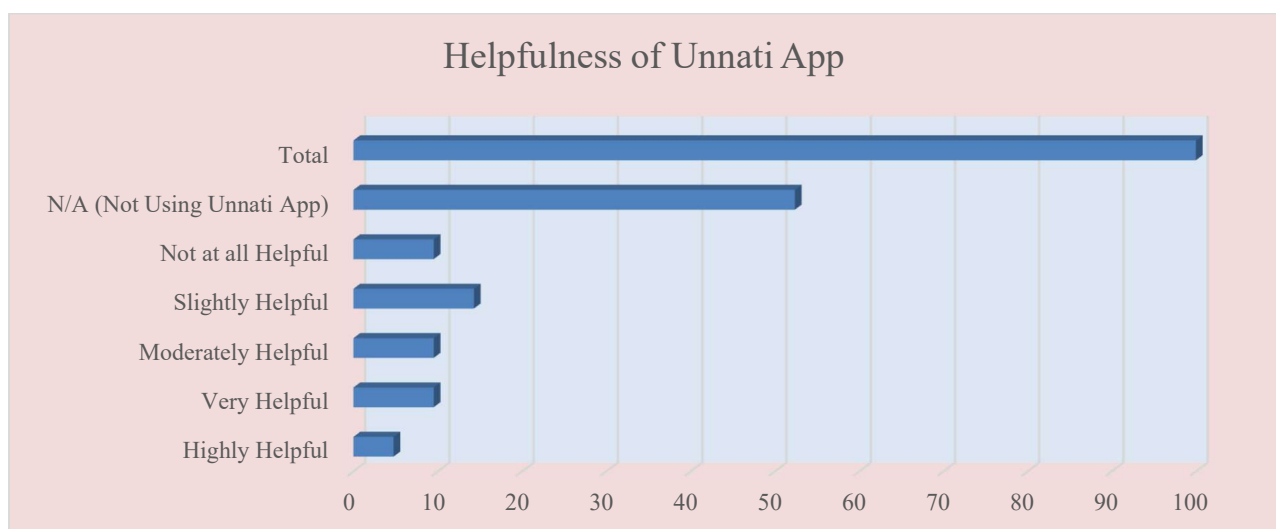


Figure 13 Helpfulness of Unnati App (Source: Primary Data)

Findings and Interpretation: The findings indicate varying perceptions regarding the usefulness of ITC's Unnati App among the surveyed retailers. More than half of the respondents (52.38%) selected "N/A", indicating that they were not using the application. Among the retailers who used the app, 14.29% considered it slightly helpful, while 9.52% each rated it as very helpful, moderately helpful, and not at all helpful. Only 4.76% of respondents reported that the app was highly helpful. The results suggest that the adoption of ITC's Unnati App among the surveyed retailers remains limited. While some users reported positive experiences and found the application useful for business-related activities, others perceived only limited benefits. The large proportion of non-users indicates that there is considerable scope for improving awareness, adoption, and engagement with the application. Enhancing the features, usability, and communication of benefits associated with the Unnati App may encourage greater utilization among retailers.

3.5.2 Technical Support Experience

The responses regarding technical support from ITC were limited because a significant proportion of respondents were not users of the Unnati App. Out of 21 respondents, 11 selected N/A and therefore were excluded from the assessment of technical support. The findings are based only on those retailers who had experience using the application.

Interpretation: The responses regarding technical support from ITC were limited, as nearly half of the respondents were not users of the Unnati App. Among those who responded, perceptions of technical support were mixed, with some retailers expressing dissatisfaction. This suggests that there is scope for improving technical assistance and retailer engagement for users of digital platforms.

3.6 Overall Interpretation

The study reveals that technology has become an integral part of retail business operations, with all surveyed retailers reporting the use of at least one technological tool in their business activities. The findings indicate that retailers primarily adopt technology due to customer demand, time-saving benefits, and ease of maintaining business records.

The analysis further shows that technology has contributed to improving various aspects of retail operations, including order placement, record maintenance, and business management. Digital tools such as UPI, WhatsApp, billing software, and ITC's Unnati App are being utilized to support day-to-day business activities. Among these, UPI emerged as the most widely adopted technology among the surveyed retailers.

The study also highlights that retailers strongly recognize the importance of technology for business growth. However, awareness of ITC schemes through technology and adoption of the Unnati App remain relatively limited among some retailers. In addition, retailers reported mixed experiences regarding technical support and ease of learning technological applications.

Overall, the findings suggest that technology plays a significant role in enhancing retail business operations and supporting business growth. However, there remains scope for improving retailer awareness, training, technical assistance, and engagement to ensure more effective utilization of technological platforms.

Chapter 4

Findings and Recommendations

4.1 Findings of the Study

Based on the analysis and interpretation of data, the following key findings have been observed:

- **Universal Adoption of Technology**

All retailers (100%) are using some form of technology in their business, such as UPI, WhatsApp, or billing software. This indicates that technology has become an essential part of retail operations.

- **Dominance of Basic Digital Tools**

UPI is the most widely adopted technology among retailers, followed by ITC's Unnati App and WhatsApp, whereas the usage of billing software remains relatively low.

- **Retailers' Association with ITC**

Most retailers have been associated with ITC for more than one year, with the largest group (38.10%) reporting an association period of 3–5 years. This suggests that the respondents possess reasonable experience in dealing with ITC products and systems.

- **Key Reasons for Using Technology**

Customer demand emerged as the most important reason for adopting technology, followed by time-saving benefits and ease of maintaining records. Retailers also reported that technology helps in tracking sales and improving transparency. These findings indicate that both customer expectations and operational efficiency drive technology adoption among retailers.

- **Improved Ease of Doing Business**

Technology has improved several aspects of business operations, particularly record maintenance, error reduction, and order placement. Retailers reported that technology helps maintain business records efficiently and reduces operational errors. However, awareness of ITC schemes through technology was found to be relatively low, indicating a need for better communication and awareness initiatives.

- **Mixed Experience in Learning Technology**

Retailers reported mixed experiences regarding the ease of learning technology. While some respondents found technology easy to use, others faced difficulties in adapting to digital tools.

- **Mixed Retailer Experience**

Retailers recognized the importance of technology for business growth; however, concerns regarding ease of learning and technical support indicate scope for improvement.

- **Existence of Minor Challenges**

Retailers face occasional issues while using technology, mainly related to usability and technical support.

- **Technology as a Growth Driver**

A majority of retailers believe that technology plays an important role in business growth and efficiency.

4.2 Suggestions

Based on the findings of the study, the following suggestions are recommended:

1. **Increase Awareness of ITC Digital Platforms**

ITC should focus on promoting its digital tools like the Unnati App among retailers to increase adoption.

2. **Provide Training and Support**

Regular training sessions should be conducted to help retailers understand and effectively use digital tools.

3. **Simplify Technology Interfaces**

Applications should be made more user-friendly to ensure easy adoption, especially for retailers with limited digital literacy.

4. **Improve Technical Support**

ITC should strengthen its technical support system to address issues faced by retailers quickly and efficiently.

5. **Improve Awareness of Schemes**

Since awareness of ITC schemes through technology was found to be relatively low, ITC should strengthen communication regarding retailer schemes and promotional programs through digital channels.

6. **Encourage Advanced Technology Adoption**

Retailers should be encouraged to move beyond basic tools like UPI and adopt more integrated systems for better efficiency.

Chapter 5

Conclusion

Conclusion

The study concludes that technology plays a crucial role in improving the efficiency and growth of retail businesses. Retailers have widely adopted basic digital tools such as UPI, WhatsApp, and billing software, which have helped in simplifying business operations.

While the overall experience of retailers is positive, there is still scope for improvement in terms of awareness, training, and technical support. Companies like ITC can further strengthen their digital ecosystem by focusing on user-friendly applications and better retailer engagement.

Overall, technology has become an essential part of modern retail business. The findings of the study indicate that technology contributes to operational efficiency, ease of doing business, and business growth among retailers associated with ITC Limited. Its effective utilization can support improved performance and long-term growth.

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ANNEXURE

ANNEXURE – I: QUESTIONNAIRE

Retailers’ Perspective on the Use of Technology for Growth and Business: A Study with ITC, Guwahati

1. Beat / Market Area

2. Type of Shop

- ☐ Grocery Store
 - ☐ Wholesaler
 - ☐ Departmental Store
 - ☐ Other
-

3. Average Daily Footfall

- ☐ Less than 20 people
 - ☐ 20 to 50 people
 - ☐ 50 to 80 people
 - ☐ 80 to 100 people
 - ☐ More than 100 people
-

4. Years of Association with ITC

- ☐ Less than a Year
 - ☐ 1–3 Years
 - ☐ 3–5 Years
 - ☐ 5–10 Years
 - ☐ More than 10 Years
-

5. Are you using any form of technology?

- ☐ Yes
 - ☐ No
-

6. Technologies Used (Multiple options allowed)

- ☐ Billing Software
 - ☐ UPI
 - ☐ WhatsApp Order
 - ☐ ITC Unnati App
 - ☐ None
-

7. Reason for Using Technology

- ☐ Saves Time
 - ☐ Easy to Track Sales
 - ☐ Due to Customer Demand
 - ☐ Transparency
 - ☐ Easy Record Keeping
 - ☐ Other
-

8. Ease of Learning Technology

1 2 3 4 5

(Very Difficult → Very Easy)

9. Order Placement Ease

1 2 3 4 5

10. Scheme Awareness

1 2 3 4 5

11. Error Reduction

1 2 3 4 5

12. Saves Time Daily

1 2 3 4 5

13. Easy Record Keeping

1 2 3 4 5

14. Are you using ITC's Unnati App?

☐ Yes

☐ No

15. Helpfulness of Unnati App

☐ Highly Helpful

☐ Very Helpful

☐ Moderately Helpful

☐ Slightly Helpful

☐ Not Helpful

16. Satisfaction with Unnati App

1 2 3 4 5

17. Have you faced issues while using technology?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Sometimes

18. If yes, describe the issue:

19. Technical Support from ITC

1 2 3 4 5

20. Is technology important for business growth?

1 2 3 4 5

21. Suggestions for improvement:

22. Will more technology help retailers grow?

1 2 3 4 5

23. Should companies provide training?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not Sure

24. Any other feedback:

ANNEXURE – II: FIELD WORK EVIDENCE.

Photo of survey



Screenshot of Data collection

The screenshot displays the SurveyHeart application interface. A modal window titled "1. Beat / Market Area" is open, showing a list of 21 responses. The modal includes a "Responses" count of 21, a "Tabular View" button, and a "Print" button. The background interface shows a sidebar with navigation options: Overview, Individual, Tabular, and Download. The main header area displays the title "Retailers' perspective on use of Technology for growth of Business" and a progress bar indicating 0GB / 1GB. The bottom of the screen shows a "FREE" status, an "Upgrade" button, and a "Wholesaler" category selected.

S.No	Submitted time	Responses
9	19 Aug 2025 - 12:59 PM	Krishna nagar
8	19 Aug 2025 - 12:35 PM	Krishna nagar
7	19 Aug 2025 - 12:23 PM	Krishna nagar
6	19 Aug 2025 - 12:04 PM	Krishna nagar
5	19 Aug 2025 - 11:59 AM	Krishna nagar
4	19 Aug 2025 - 11:47 AM	Krishna nagar
3	19 Aug 2025 - 11:44 AM	Krishna nagar
2	19 Aug 2025 - 11:42 AM	Krishna nagar
1	19 Aug 2025 - 10:32 AM	Ghoramara